

Facility Options Brief

Every realistic path to a place we can gather 1,000–1,500 for worship — the cost, how each option wins, how each one loses, and where every number comes from. This is to inform the committee's decision, not to make it.

Prepared by Angel Mendoza · June 2026 · Figures sourced below. Estimates are labeled; bid figures are from named contractors.

[← Project hub](#) [Sanctuary 3D \(A/B/C\)](#) [Theater 3D](#)

WHAT WE'RE SOLVING

The decision & the criteria

We need one room that seats 1,000–1,500 with a clear view to the stage from every seat. Beyond that, the committee is weighing cost, timeline, room to grow, and risk. The three realistic paths:

OPTION	MONEY IN		WORSHIP ROOM	BUILDING	TIME
1 · Build new (metal building)	\$4.7M–\$6.8M	ALL-IN	Column-free by design	~32,000 sf, new, to plan	~6–9 mo
2 · Buy & convert the theater	\$5.3M–\$10.3M		Needs column work	83,422 sf existing + parking	Months (phased)
3 · Master-lease the theater	~\$21K/mo + reno		Same as #2	Same, but rented first	Fastest start

On the numbers: the new-build figures are real contractor bids. The theater purchase is a real LOI price. The renovation and column-removal figures are planning-level estimates (labeled **ESTIMATE**) that a GC walk-through and a structural engineer convert to firm numbers. The new-build bids are turnkey (land included). All sources are listed at the bottom.

OPTION 1

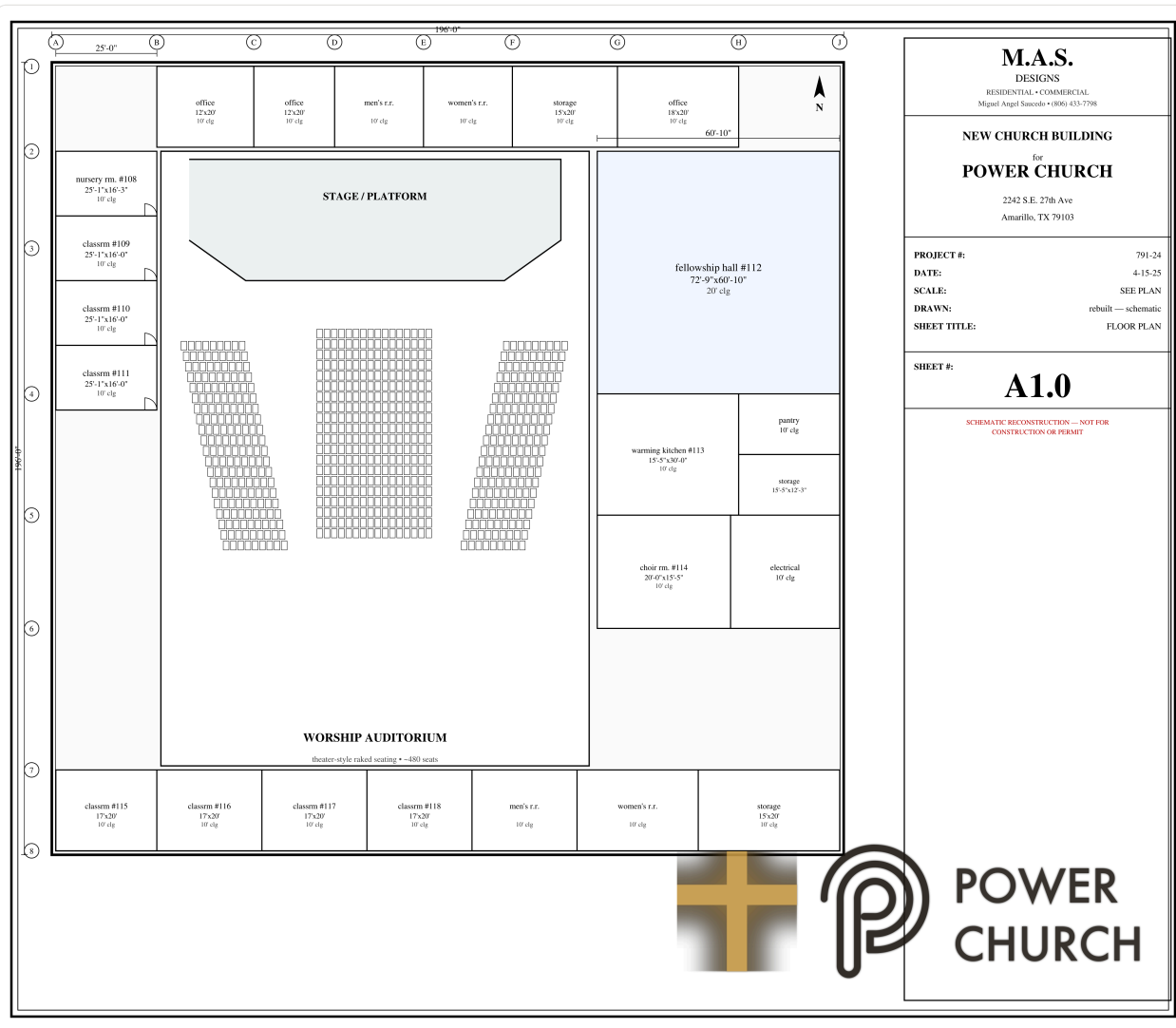
Build new — pre-engineered metal building

New 32,000 sf church **REAL BIDS**

\$4.7M – \$6.8M

All-in, land included. JOMA (Houston GC) \$4,697,000 (\$147/sf) · target Amarillo GC \$4.98M–\$5.85M (\$155–183/sf) · Caprock (local, full GMP) \$6,807,000 (\$215/sf).

A pre-engineered metal building (PEMB) with rigid frames. The frames clear-span the width, so the worship room is **column-free by design** — the exact problem we fight in the theater simply does not exist here.



HOW IT WINS

- Wide-open worship room, no posts, for \$0 extra
- Brand new, exactly to our plan, zero retrofit risk
- Lowest hard cost per the real bids
- Modern systems, low maintenance from day one

HOW IT LOSES

- Lower bid (JOMA) excludes some scope (2nd floor, landscaping); change orders can lift it
- Smaller building (32,000 sf vs 83,000)
- Full design + permit + build timeline before we worship in it
- No existing parking/site improvements included

To confirm: that the bids include land/site as quoted. Final GC selection (bids range \$147–215/sf). Whether 32,000 sf meets long-term growth.

OPTION 2

Buy & convert the theater

Former Amarillo Star — 83,422 sf **REAL LOI**

\$5.3M – \$10.3M all-in

Buy \$3.8M (LOI; listed \$5.5M) + sanctuary fit-out \$1.5M–\$3.5M **ESTIMATE** + column option below. Gets the sanctuary done; the other ~50,000 sf is additional/phased.

Convert the four center auditoriums into one sanctuary. The building already includes the structure, sprinklers, big HVAC, an elevator, and a huge parking lot. The catch is the 17 steel columns in the sanctuary — handling them is the swing:

COLUMN APPROACH	RESULT	ADDED COST
A · aisles on the column lines	Posts stand in aisles, still in the room	~\$0 EST
B · remove center + front posts	Clear view to the stage; posts remain at back/edges	\$300K–\$700K EST
C · remove every post (clear span)	Fully open, column-free room	\$1.2M–\$3M EST



HOW IT WINS

- 83,422 sf and a big parking lot — 2x+ the new build
- ~45,000 sf beyond the sanctuary for kids, offices, café, growth, even income
- Land is included in the buy
- Can phase: worship in the sanctuary while the rest is finished
- Far more building for the money: 83,000 sf + an existing parking lot vs 32,000 sf new (the extra ~50,000 sf is unfinished/phased)

HOW IT LOSES

- The column problem costs \$0.3M–\$3M to truly solve, plus engineering
- Retrofit risk: inspection flagged a **major foundation crack** + electrical item
- Old building — ongoing maintenance, aging systems
- More square footage than we may want to heat/cool/maintain
- Clear-span (C) is a real structural unknown until an engineer prices it

To confirm: structural engineer's price + sign-off on column removal and the foundation crack; a real GC bid on the fit-out; final negotiated purchase price.

SEATING STUDY

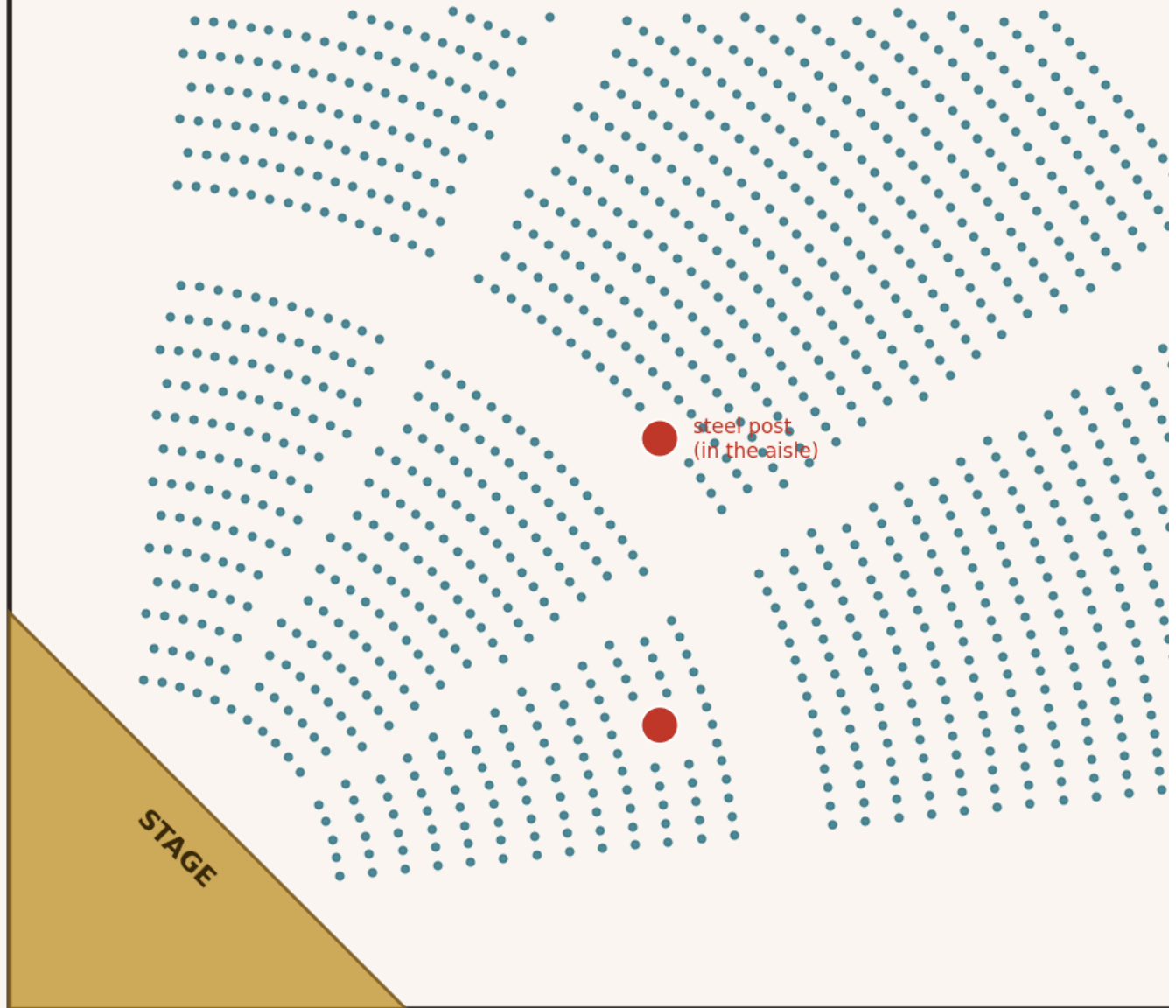
A corner stage: fewer posts, better sightlines

You don't have to combine four rooms or remove 17 posts to seat the church.

The steel columns sit on the walls between rooms, so each big auditorium is already a clear, open room. Here is how a corner (diagonal) stage plays out:

Corner-stage seating study — combined RPX + IMAX room

1179 seats fan toward one corner stage · room ~118 × 94 ft · only 2 interior posts, both in aisles



† POWER CHURCH · planning study, to be confirmed by a structural engineer

What you're seeing: the two center rooms (RPX + IMAX) opened into one, with the stage in a corner and the seats fanned toward it. About **1,180 seats**, and the only **2** interior posts both land in the aisles. A corner stage trades a few raw seats (a straight front-wall layout fits ~1,310 in the same room) for better sightlines and an intimate, everyone-facing-in feel. Want zero posts at all? A **single** auditorium with a corner stage seats roughly **800** with nothing to work around. Seat counts are planning estimates; a licensed structural engineer confirms the structure before anything is removed.

OPTION 3

Master-lease the theater (then option to buy)

Lease first, buy later

PRO FORMA

~\$20,856 / mo + reno

~\$3/sf gross master lease with option to buy at \$3.8M; rent abatement negotiable during construction. From the building committee pro forma.

Same building and same conversion as Option 2, but we lease it (with an option to buy) instead of buying up front. The renovation still happens; ownership comes later at the option price.

HOW IT WINS

- Lowest cash up front — fastest way to get in the door
- **Walkable:** if reno overruns or growth stalls, we can leave without a multi-million deficiency
- Rent abatement during construction can keep year-one cash positive
- Try the building before fully committing

HOW IT LOSES

- Rent paid during the lease isn't building equity
- The buyout refi is the hardest exit of the three (per the pro forma)
- Improving a building we don't yet own
- Same column + retrofit issues as Option 2

To confirm: will the seller master-lease, and at what rent/abatement? (A 15-minute call to the listing agent collapses this question.)

PAYING FOR IT

Financing structures on the table

From the committee pro forma — these layer onto the theater options (and partly onto new build):

STRUCTURE	SHAPE	BEST WHEN
A • Seller carry + construction loan	\$2M seller carryback (IO, balloon) + \$2M bank construction loan	Cleanest exit math; seller is willing to carry
B • Bank term loan + fundraise	\$4M term loan, raise reno during	Simple to explain, but highest risk per the pro forma
C • Master lease + buyout	Lease, then refi to buy at \$3.8M	Operationally safest; hardest refi exit

Banker on file: Amarillo National Bank. Texas Tax Code 11.20 exempts 501(c)(3) religious property from property tax if the church entity owns it (not a for-profit LLC) — a real annual savings worth confirming with the structure.

SIDE BY SIDE

The scorecard

	BUILD NEW (PEMB)	BUY + CONVERT	MASTER-LEASE
Cash to a working sanctuary	\$4.7–6.8M (land in)	\$5.3–10.3M	~\$21K/mo + reno
Column-free worship room	Yes, by design	\$0.3–3M to solve	\$0.3–3M to solve
Square footage	~32,000	83,422	83,422
Room to grow / extra space	Limited	~45,000 sf spare	~45,000 sf spare
Parking / site	Build it	Included	Included
Condition / risk	New, lowest	Old, retrofit risk	Old, + leasing risk
Walk-away flexibility	Low (own it)	Low (own it)	High
Time to worship in it	~6–9 mo	Months (phased)	Fastest

No option is the obvious winner on every line — that's the committee's call. The shortest summary: **new build** gives the cleanest, lowest-risk open room for the money; **convert** gives far more building and included land at the price of the column work and retrofit risk; **master-lease** trades equity for flexibility and the lowest entry.

THE RECEIPTS

Real data & sources

Every figure above traces to one of these. Estimates are labeled as estimates.

FIGURE	SOURCE
New build \$4.697M (JOMA), \$4.98–5.85M target, \$6.807M (Caprock), \$147–215/sf; 32,000 sf PEMB, land included	Power Church Construction Pricing Research , Apr 9 2026 (real contractor bids)
Theater \$3.8M buy (LOI), \$5.5M list, 83,422 sf, vacant 2.5 yr; financing A/B/C; master-lease \$3/sf; ANB; tax exemption	Three-Scenario Pro Forma , Building Committee, May 4 2026
Theater condition: 47 recommendations, 2 safety (major foundation crack, electrical clearance); sprinklers/HVAC/elevator present	A Better Inspection (CCPIA) , M. Morton, Certified Master Inspector, May 19 2026
14 auditoriums, 3,110 seats (108 IMAX 448, 107 RPX 448...); 17 tube-steel columns, ~30 ft grid; ~12,100 sf combined sanctuary → ~1,850 church seats	Original Amarillo Star construction CAD (7033 set, COL-TS-C columns), read via LibreDWG / ezdxf
New church floor plan (image)	M.A.S. Designs (Miguel A. Saucedo), Sheet A1.0, Project 791-24
Fit-out \$1.5–3.5M; column options A \$0 / B \$300–700K / C \$1.2–3M	Planning-level estimates (Class 5, –30%/+50%) — to be firmed by a GC walk-through + structural engineer

Prepared for the **Power Church Building Committee** · Pastor Manny De Los Santos. The committee decides direction; this brief exists to put every option and its real numbers on the table. Planning-level figures are labeled and require a contractor bid and structural engineer to finalize. Live 3D models and downloads at the [project hub](#).